

MAKE IT (DY)NASTY

THE LEAGUE LETTER · NO. 2 · SEPTEMBER 5, 2026

The offseason already had a winner

Thirteen trades and fifty-four waiver claims in forty-seven days. Three of the twelve rows on the odds board moved ten points or more, and the two names the July letter was built around each went the other way.

FROM THE DESK · 47 DAYS AFTER "BLOOD ON HIS HANDS"

UNEDITED DRAFT

A machine-written first pass for Nick to rewrite in his own words. It is not finished copy and it is not for the group chat as it stands. The reporting is sourced; the writing is scaffolding.

Every figure in this draft was computed from files in this folder (see the appendix). Nothing is from memory. Every claim about a manager is a transaction in the league's Sleeper log or a row on the odds page; there are no quotes, no characterizations, and no guesses about anyone's intent. The odds site is unnamed in the July article and is flagged below.

Good evening. Or good whatever hour it is when you're reading this on your phone in a parking lot. Sleeper says the season starts Wednesday. The league's own numbers say the offseason already had a winner, and it isn't who the July edition would have guessed.

Forty-seven days ago this desk ran a story called "Blood on His Hands." Three of the twelve rows on that odds board have moved ten points or more since. Two of those three are the two names the July story was built around, and each went the other way.

Start at the bottom of the July board and work up. zhyman was the ten seed at 32 percent to make the playoffs. Tonight he is the eight seed at 47. That is plus fifteen, the largest move on the board in either direction, and seven and a half times the page's stated error margin. His transaction log for the window contains one entry. On July 21 he released a kicker. That

is the whole log. No trades, no claims, no bids. The kicker was Cairo Santos. We are not saying these two facts are related. We are saying they are in the same paragraph.

The July buyer went the other way. bryansquared was the four seed at 66 percent with the best bye odds in the league at 34. He is now the six seed at 56, bye odds 25, title odds down from 12 to 8. And here is the part the desk found while pulling the ledger. The three players he pried out of zhyman on July 20, Jonathan Taylor, James Cook, and George Kittle, are all gone. Taylor went to mattkendall1 on August 20 for Breece Hall, Christian Watson, and two 2028 thirds. Cook and Kittle went to DDooGZ on August 23, with a 2028 third, for De'Von Achane, Chris Godwin, and a 2029 fifth. The Monday Morning Massacre lasted thirty-four days. FantasyCalc scores the Taylor deal as more value coming back to him (7,955 to 5,599). It scores the Achane deal the other way (7,796 received, 8,574 sent). KeepTradeCut's page feed, which carries no picks, calls the second one a coin flip: 10,026 to 9,973.

The biggest trade of the window by total value wasn't his. On August 11, CharmCity20 and chrisappegate moved 24,997 points of FantasyCalc value between them, the most of any deal since July. CharmCity20 got Drake London, Kenneth Walker, Dallas Goedert, and chrisappegate's 2028 first. chrisappegate got Trey McBride, DeVonta Smith, and Aaron Rodgers. FantasyCalc gives CharmCity20 the edge, 13,333 to 11,664. KeepTradeCut has it 15,113 to 14,740. Rotowire's season projections on Sleeper lean the other way, 641 points to 630. Three sources, two winners, one conclusion: it was close, and everyone involved will tell you otherwise. Since then chrisappegate sits at 78 percent, still the one seed, and his bye odds went from 31 to 38. That plus seven is the largest bye gain on the board.

About CharmCity20. Thirteen trades cleared in the window. He was in six of them. On August 8 the league completed four trades in seven hours; he was in one. On August 13 it completed three trades in eighty-three minutes; he was in two of those, one minute apart at 10:06 and 10:07 PM.

The waiver wire, where dynasty leagues go to feel productive. Fifty-four pickups since July 20, every one of them a waiver claim, and the most valuable of them by FantasyCalc was free. Keenan Allen, value 1,031, was dropped by brochillington on July 24 and claimed by bryansquared on July 31 for zero dollars. Third on the list, Najee Harris, was dropped by ljwestwood on July 30 and claimed by DDooGZ on August 20, also for zero. Fourth, Pat Freiermuth, dropped by ljwestwood August 5, claimed by itsders August 7 at zero; ChessNerd420's claim on the same player failed the same morning. The pattern here isn't complicated. The best players on the wire were on rosters in this league two weeks earlier.

The actual money went elsewhere. The two largest winning bids of the window were both 101 dollars: DDooGZ on Darren Waller, and itsders on Xavier Hutchinson, whom FantasyCalc ranks 321st. Same price, 84 ranking spots apart. brochillington spent the most in the window, 149 dollars across nine claims, including 69 each on Haynes King and Charlie Kolar. bryansquared won eleven claims, the most in the league, and had five claims fail, also the most in the league.

The rest of the board, briefly. DDooGZ, four trades and six claims deep, is at 77 percent, up four, and his semifinal odds went from 45 to 49. Lupeeeeeeee's bye odds went from 23 to 28 on two trades and zero claims. mattkendall1's playoff odds didn't move at all, 66 and 66, while his bye odds went from 25 to 18 and his semifinal odds from 56 to 45, tied with bryansquared for the biggest semifinal drop on the page. ljwestwood went from 44 to 36 and from the nine seed to the ten. And brochillington went from 15 percent to 5 and from eleventh to twelfth, on three trades and nine claims. The desk was told to report the numbers. These are the numbers.

And one more thing. This league's trade deadline, per the settings page on Sleeper, is week 99. The playoffs start in week 15. There is no deadline. Thirteen trades in forty-seven days, and it's the part of the calendar where nothing happens. Sleep well.

APPENDIX

Every figure above, with its source and the command that produced it.

A. Playoff odds, July 20 vs September 5

Source: Nick's screenshot of the league's playoff-simulation page, taken 2026-09-05 11:11 ET, transcribed to `playoff-odds-2026-09-05.csv`. The July 20 baseline is the table in the July article (`playoff-odds-2026-07-20.csv`, README beside it). **Flag:** the July article attributes its odds to "league playoff simulations, error margin $\pm 2.0\%$ " and never names the site, so this draft can't either. The page's stated margin is $\pm 2.0\%$; * marks moves larger than that. `<1%` is recorded as 0.5.

TEAM	RANK JUL 20 -> SEP 5	PLAYOFFS JUL 20 -> SEP 5	DELTA	BYE JUL 20 -> SEP 5	DELTA	TITLE JUL 20 -> SEP 5	DELTA
zhyman	10 -> 8	32% -> 47%	+15 *	8% -> 11%	+3 *	2% -> 4%	+2
DD00GZ	2 -> 2	73% -> 77%	+4 *	27% -> 27%	0	14% -> 16%	+2
chrisapplegate	1 -> 1	75% -> 78%	+3 *	31% -> 38%	+7 *	18% -> 19%	+1
CharmCity20	6 -> 5	61% -> 63%	+2	27% -> 25%	-2	13% -> 14%	+1
ChessNerd420	12 -> 11	4% -> 6%	+2	<1% -> <1%	0	<1% -> <1%	0
Lupeeeeeeeee	3 -> 3	71% -> 72%	+1	23% -> 28%	+5 *	15% -> 15%	0
GKrebs	7 -> 7	46% -> 47%	+1	9% -> 13%	+4 *	6% -> 5%	-1
mattkendall1	5 -> 4	66% -> 66%	0	25% -> 18%	-7 *	10% -> 11%	+1
itsders	8 -> 9	46% -> 46%	0	5% -> 8%	+3 *	3% -> 4%	+1
ljwestwood	9 -> 10	44% -> 36%	-8 *	13% -> 7%	-6 *	6% -> 3%	-3 *
bryansquared	4 -> 6	66% -> 56%	-10 *	34% -> 25%	-9 *	12% -> 8%	-4 *
brochillington	11 -> 12	15% -> 5%	-10 *	3% -> 1%	-2	<1% -> <1%	0

Semifinal odds (same sources): mattkendall1 56 -> 45, bryansquared 56 -> 45, zhyman 18 -> 26, DD00GZ 45 -> 49, brochillington 7 -> 2. Full semis and finals table: `derived/odds-delta.md`. Derivation: `python3 odds_delta.py`.

B. Trades since July 20, ranked by total FantasyCalc value moved

Sources: Sleeper transactions (`data/transactions-week1.json`; the whole 2026 log lives in week 1, weeks 0, 2 and 3 returned empty), player names from `data/players.json`, FantasyCalc dynasty values (12-team, 2 QB, PPR) from `data/fantasycalc-dynasty-12team-2qb-ppr.json` joined on Sleeper id, KeepTradeCut superflex values from `data/ktc-superflex.json` (players only; the KTC page's `playersArray` contains no picks), Rotowire season projections via Sleeper (`data/sleeper-projections-2026-regular.json`, `pts_ppr`; note the league adds +0.5 per TE reception, which `pts_ppr` doesn't). Picks are valued at FantasyCalc's un-slotted generic value (e.g. "2028 1st" = 2,131); 2027 and 2029 fifth-rounders have no FantasyCalc entry. Window = `status_updated` after 2026-07-20 12:00 ET.

#	DATE (ET)	SIDE A RECEIVES	FC	KTC	PROJ	SIDE B RECEIVES	FC	KTC	PROJ
1	Aug 11	CharmCity20: London, K. Walker, Goedert, 2028 1st (chrisapplegate)	13,333	15,113	630.2	chrisapplegate: McBride, D. Smith, Rodgers	11,664	14,740	641.1
2	Aug 23	bryansquared: Achane, Godwin, 2029 5th (DD00GZ)	7,796	10,026	431.0	DD00GZ: Cook, Kittle, 2028 3rd (DD00GZ)	8,574	9,973	430.1
3	Aug 20	bryansquared: B. Hall, C. Watson, 2028 3rd (mattkendall1), 2028 3rd (DD00GZ)	7,955	9,446	418.6	mattkendall1: J. Taylor	5,599	6,422	272.3
4	Aug 7	brochillington: Pickens, J. Brooks	7,030	9,954	400.6	itsders: T. Lawrence, 2027 3rd (bryansquared)	6,305	6,344	303.4
5	Aug 8	brochillington: Stribling, 2027 1st (Lupeeeeeeeee), 2027 2nd (DD00GZ)	6,688	4,059	128.4	Lupeeeeeeeee: Pickens, 2027 3rd (Lupeeeeeeeee)	6,154	6,273	245.7
6	Aug 8	ljwestwood: Bo Nix, 2028 3rd (brochillington)	5,856	5,999	295.7	Lupeeeeeeeee: Jaxson Dart	5,111	5,820	296.5
7	Aug 8	GKrebs: D. Adams, K. Pitts	5,147	7,781	364.1	DD00GZ: Garrett Wilson	3,993	5,615	224.9
8	Aug 8	CharmCity20: J. Brooks, Travis Hunter	3,671	6,568	255.5	brochillington: Kenyon Sadiq	2,393	3,609	100.2
9	Aug 13	CharmCity20: Kincaid, 2029 4th (GKrebs)	2,872	3,256	163.6	GKrebs: Darnold	2,838	4,262	262.7
10	Aug 13	ljwestwood: Michael Wilson	2,157	3,799	166.0	DD00GZ: RJ Harvey	1,864	3,299	144.1
11	Aug 13	ljwestwood: 2027 3rd (mattkendall1), 2029 2nd (CharmCity20)	2,350	n/a	n/a	CharmCity20: Terrance Ferguson	1,652	3,074	100.3
12	Aug 24	DD00GZ: Ray Davis, 2027 5th (CharmCity20, unvalued)	640	2,014	65.1	CharmCity20: 2028 4th (DD00GZ)	800	n/a	n/a
13	Aug 11	ljwestwood: Troy Franklin	611	2,336	66.1	CharmCity20: 2029 4th (ljwestwood)	778	n/a	n/a

Per-asset detail for every trade: `derived/transactions.md`. Trades per manager in the window: CharmCity20 6, DD00GZ 4, ljwestwood 4, brochillington 3, bryansquared 2, GKrebs 2, Lupeeeeeeeee 2, chrisapplegate 1, itsders 1, mattkendall1 1, ChessNerd420 0, zhyman 0.

C. Waiver pickups since July 20, top 12 by FantasyCalc value

Same sources as B. All 54 pickups in the window were waiver claims (no free-agent adds); bids are FAAB dollars from the transaction's `settings.waiver_bid`. Age is from the Sleeper player map.

#	PLAYER	POS	TEAM	AGE	CLAIMED BY	DATE	BID	FC VALUE	FC RANK	KTC SF	PROJ PPR (ROTOWIRE VIA SLEEPER)
1	Keenan Allen	WR	IND	34	bryansquared	Jul 31	\$0	1,031	210	1,713	106.8
2	Malik Davis	RB	DAL	27	bryansquared	Aug 26	\$0	1,024	211	1,947	68.9
3	Najee Harris	RB	NYG	28	DD00GZ	Aug 20	\$0	950	214	1,757	26.3
4	Pat Freiermuth	TE	PIT	27	itsders	Aug 7	\$0	901	217	2,149	128.4
5	Devaughn Vele	WR	NO	28	ChessNerd420	Aug 18	\$0	724	230	1,838	110.6
6	Jaylen Wright	RB	MIA	23	GKrebs	Aug 1	\$0	717	231	2,166	44.1
7	Jacob Saylor	RB	DET	25	CharmCity20	Aug 31	\$0	641	235	1,406	25.5
8	Darren Waller	TE	CAR	33	DD00GZ	Aug 13	\$101	639	237	1,281	122.6
9	George Holani	RB	SEA	26	CharmCity20	Jul 24	\$0	635	238	1,784	25.2
10	Chris Brooks	RB	GB	26	brochillington	Jul 24	\$2	487	257	1,741	56.3

#	PLAYER	POS	TEAM	AGE	CLAIMED BY	DATE	BID	FC VALUE	FC RANK	KTC SF	PROJ PPR (ROTOWIRE VIA SLEEPER)
11	Sean Tucker	RB	TB	24	GKrebs	Aug 24	\$0	480	261	2,094	52.5
12	Jack Strand	QB	ATL	22	bryansquared	Aug 23	\$31	419	264	1,545	n/a

Largest winning bids in the window: \$101 itsders on Xavier Hutchinson (FC 158, rank 321, KTC 2,015), \$101 DD00GZ on Darren Waller, \$69 brochillington on Haynes King, \$69 brochillington on Charlie Kolar, \$31 bryansquared on Jack Strand. Claims won / failed / FAAB spent in the window: bryansquared 11 / 5 / \$34, brochillington 9 / 0 / \$149, DD00GZ 6 / 0 / \$101, ChessNerd420 6 / 1 / \$0, chrisapplegate 5 / 0 / \$11, GKrebs 4 / 0 / \$0, itsders 4 / 0 / \$101, ljwestwood 4 / 0 / \$0, mattkendall1 3 / 0 / \$0, CharmCity20 2 / 0 / \$0, Lupeeeeeeeee 0, zhyman 0 (one drop-only move, Cairo Santos, Jul 21). Full pickup and drop tables: `derived/transactions.md`.

Provenance of the three drop-then-claim pairs named in the piece (all from `data/transactions-week1.json`): Keenan Allen dropped by brochillington Jul 24 11:06 AM, claimed by bryansquared Jul 31 11:06 AM. Najee Harris dropped by ljwestwood Jul 30 11:06 AM, claimed by DD00GZ Aug 20 11:07 AM. Pat Freiermuth dropped by ljwestwood Aug 5 11:06 AM, claimed by itsders Aug 7 11:06 AM; ChessNerd420's claim on Freiermuth failed Aug 7 11:06 AM.

D. Other facts used in the piece

- Season start 2026-09-09, current week 1: `data/state.json` (`peek-sleeper state`).
- Trade deadline week 99, 6 playoff teams, playoffs start week 15, FAAB budget 1000, 12 rosters: `data/league.json` (`peek-sleeper league 1312130398133694464`).
- The July 20 zhyman-bryansquared trade (Taylor, Cook, Kittle for Kyren Williams, Corum, Skattebo, Likely, Gadsden) at 11:53 AM ET: `data/transactions-week1.json`. Current holders per `data/rosters.json`: Taylor on mattkendall1, Cook and Kittle on DD00GZ.
- Trade timing clusters: Aug 8 trades at 10:36 AM, 2:47 PM, 4:16 PM, 5:38 PM (four in seven hours; CharmCity20 in the 4:16 PM one). Aug 13 trades at 8:44 PM, 10:06 PM, 10:07 PM (CharmCity20 in the last two).
- Days between articles: July 20 to September 5 is 47 days.
- "seven times the error margin": $15 / 2.0 = 7.5$.

E. Value sources available

SOURCE	STATUS	ROUTE
FantasyCalc dynasty values	available	<code>api.fantasycalc.com/values/current?isDynasty=true&numQbs=2&numTeams=12&ppr=1</code> (same parameters as <code>~/projects/dynasty-dashboard/ingestion/fantasycalc.py</code>)
KeepTradeCut superflex values	available, players only	<code>keeptradeCut.com/dynasty-rankings</code> , page-embedded <code>playersArray</code> , <code>superflexValues.value</code> (same route as <code>~/projects/dynasty-dashboard/ingestion/ktc.py</code>)
Season projections	available	<code>api.sleeper.com/projections/nfl/2026?season_type=regular</code> , <code>stats.pts_ppr</code> , <code>company</code> = rotowire (same route as <code>~/projects/dynasty-dashboard/ingestion/projections.py</code>)

SOURCE	STATUS	ROUTE
Playoff odds	screenshot only	site unnamed in the July article; see A

F. Scripts and reproduction

Tool: `/Users/nick/bin/peek-sleeper` (stdlib Python, read-only, no token; big feeds cached one day under `~/ .cache/peek-sleeper/`, `--fresh` bypasses).

```
cd /Users/nick/sq-data/make-it-dynasty/2026-09-05
L=1312130398133694464
peek-sleeper state --json > data/state.json
peek-sleeper league $L --json > data/league.json
peek-sleeper users $L --json > data/users.json
peek-sleeper rosters $L --json > data/rosters.json
peek-sleeper picks $L --json > data/traded_picks.json
for w in 0 1 2 3; do peek-sleeper transactions $L $w --json > data/transactions-week$w.json; done
peek-sleeper players --json > data/players.json
peek-sleeper values --json > data/fantasycalc-dynasty-12team-2qb-ppr.json
peek-sleeper ktc --json > data/ktc-superflex.json
peek-sleeper projections 2026 --json > data/sleeper-projections-2026-regular.json
peek-sleeper trending add --hours 24 -n 50 --json > data/trending-add-24h.json
peek-sleeper trending drop --hours 24 -n 50 --json > data/trending-drop-24h.json
python3 odds_delta.py > derived/odds-delta.md # plus --json
python3 transactions.py > derived/transactions.md # plus --json
```

Pulled 2026-09-05 11:20 EDT (`data/PULLED_AT.txt`). Prior-art recall for the July article: `recall/1f6d7208/` (prompts, tail, inventory, and the Sleeper pull scripts from that session); the article itself is the artifact at <https://claude.ai/code/artifact/2431d052-93d2-49a1-95e3-e9a6afa78df1>.

G. Things to check before this goes anywhere

- The odds site is unnamed. If Nick knows it, name it in A and in the piece.
- The July 20 baseline was transcribed from a screenshot in the July session; that session flagged brochillington's semis/finals cells as hard to read. The piece only uses his playoffs, bye, and semis figures.
- Ages come from Sleeper's player map, projections from Rotowire via Sleeper without the league's TE premium, and pick values are FantasyCalc's generic un-slotted numbers. None of the three value sources is the league's own.
- The Sleeper trending feed (`data/trending-add-24h.json`) is site-wide, not league-specific, and is not used in the piece.